

Did a commitment statement improve HINTS 7 data quality?

Pre-registered RCT, HINTS 7 (2024) · plan locked **2026-09-02** (commit 238c6c8) · ITT: **n = 1,513** statement arm vs **n = 5,765** everyone else.

HYPOTHESIS

H1 ITEM NONRESPONSE

H2 BREAK-OFF (WEB ONLY)

H3 RESPONSE ERROR

PROVENANCE

Pre-registered

Post-hoc and descriptive panels are on pages 2–3

EFFECT, PERCENTAGE POINTS

-0.21 pp [-0.437, 0.012] pp

RATES

Treatment 1.22% [1.040, 1.406] vs Control 1.44% [1.306, 1.566]

ARMS

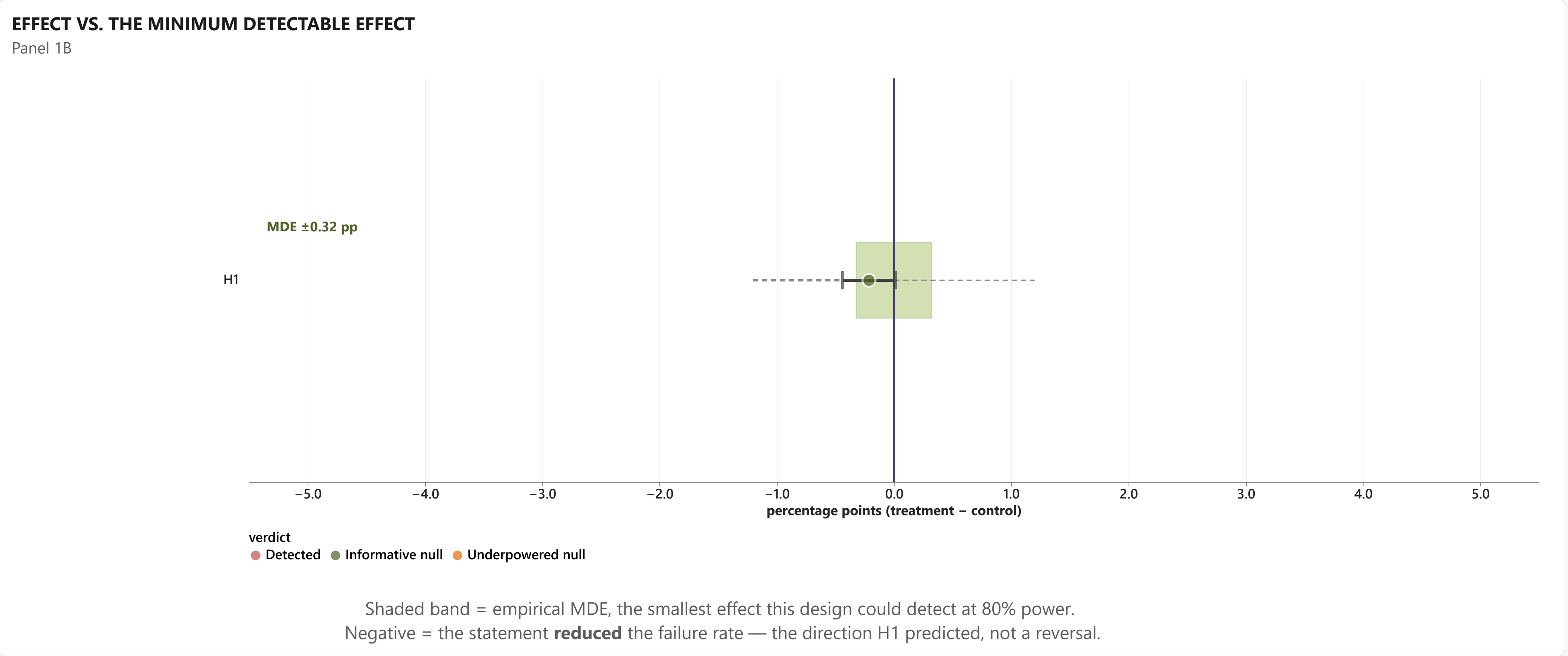
Treatment n = 1,513 | Control n = 5,765

SIGNIFICANCE

p = 0.063 uncorrected | p = 0.190 Holm (family of 3)

VERDICT

No effect on item nonresponse (–0.21 pp). The study could reliably detect changes this small — this is a real null, not an inconclusive test.



Did a commitment statement improve HINTS 7 data quality?

Pre-registered RCT, HINTS 7 (2024) · plan locked **2026-09-02** (commit 238c6c8) · ITT: **n = 1,513** statement arm vs **n = 5,765** everyone else.

HYPOTHESIS

- H1 ITEM NONRESPONSE
- H2 BREAK-OFF (WEB ONLY)
- H3 RESPONSE ERROR

PROVENANCE

Pre-registered

Post-hoc and descriptive panels are on pages 2–3

EFFECT, PERCENTAGE POINTS

+1.81 pp [-1.172, 4.802] pp

RATES

Treatment 6.94% [4.139, 9.737] vs Control 5.12% [4.080, 6.167]

ARMS

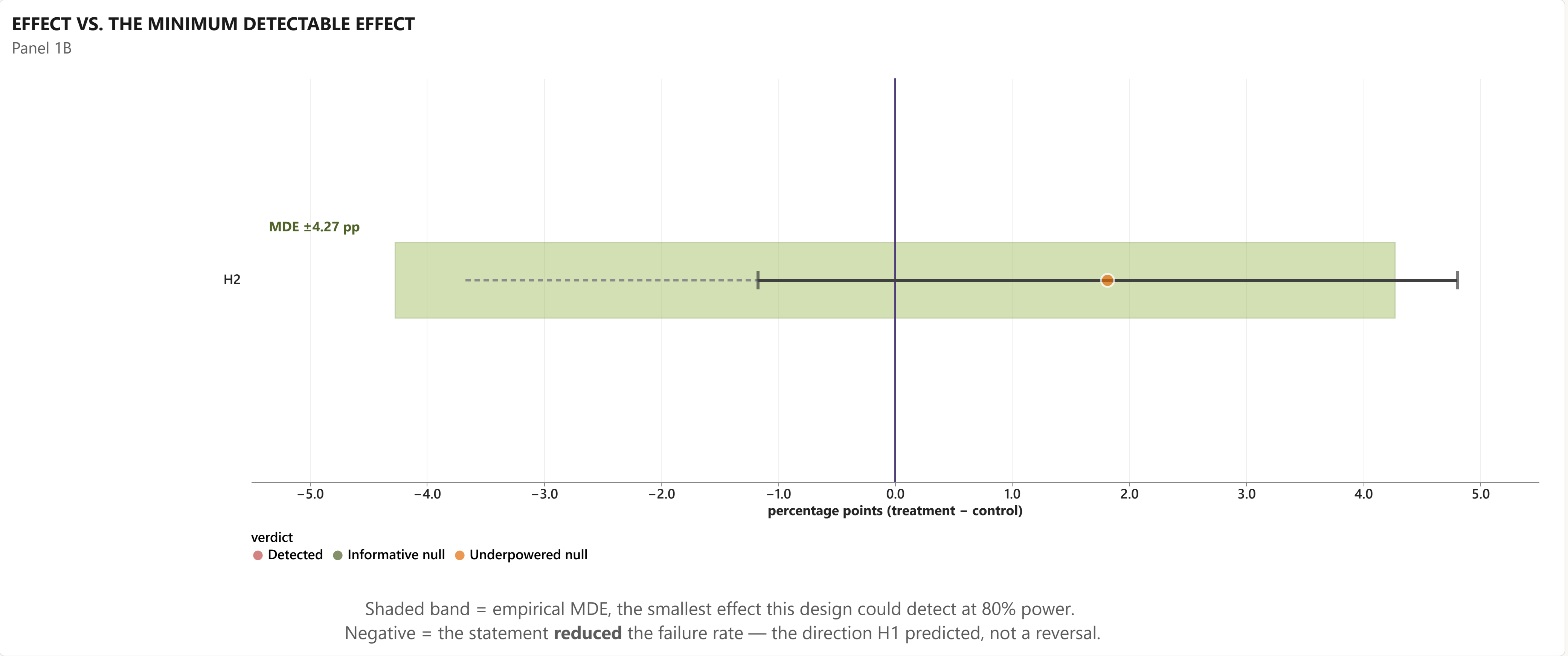
Treatment n = 1,061 | Control n = 3,800

SIGNIFICANCE

p = 0.234 uncorrected | p = 0.467 Holm (family of 3)

VERDICT

No reliable effect on web break-off. If anything it rose slightly (+1.82 pp), but couldn't confirm or rule out an effect.



Did a commitment statement improve HINTS 7 data quality?

Pre-registered RCT, HINTS 7 (2024) · plan locked **2026-09-02** (commit 238c6c8) · ITT: **n = 1,513** statement arm vs **n = 5,765** everyone else.

HYPOTHESIS

H1 ITEM NONRESPONSE

H2 BREAK-OFF (WEB ONLY)

H3 RESPONSE ERROR

PROVENANCE

Pre-registered

Post-hoc and descriptive panels are on pages 2–3

EFFECT, PERCENTAGE POINTS

-0.02 pp [-0.104, 0.062] pp

RATES

Treatment 0.34% [0.268, 0.420] vs Control 0.36% [0.332, 0.398]

ARMS

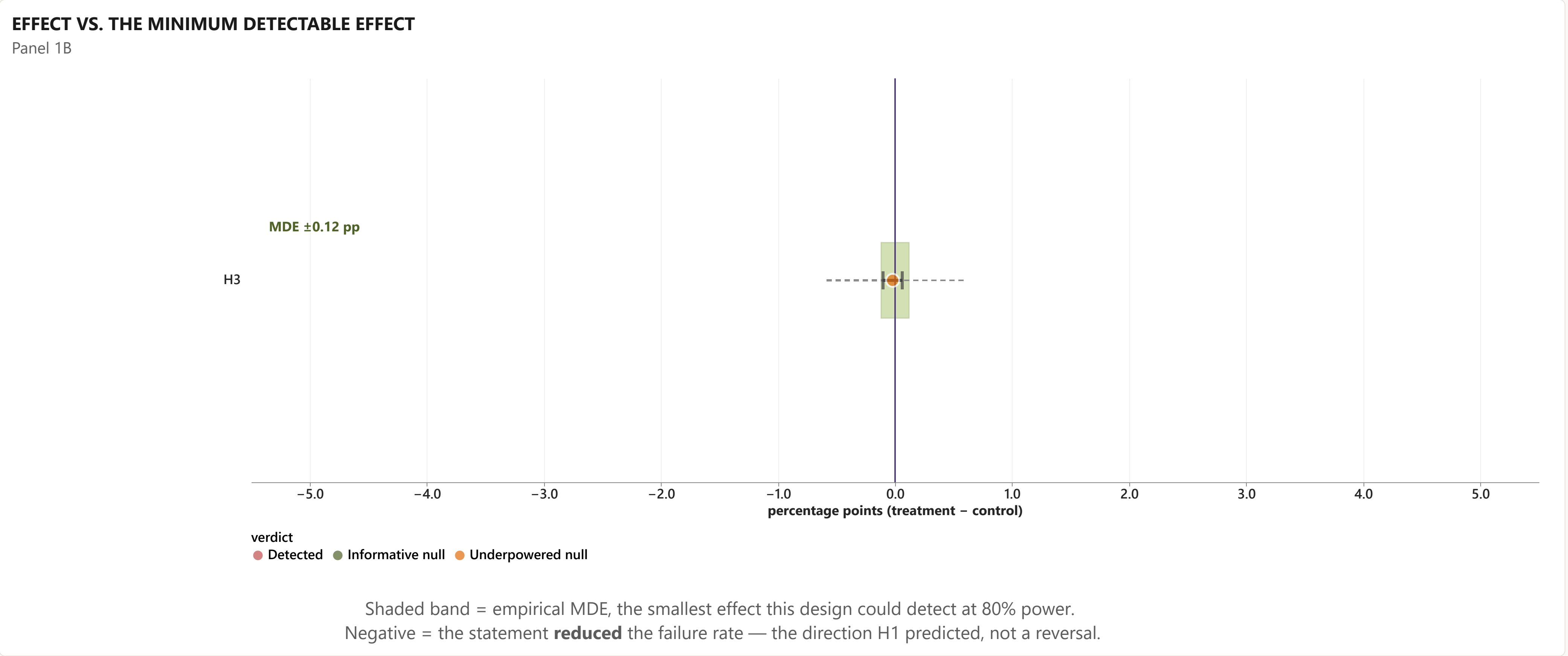
Treatment n = 1,513 | Control n = 5,765

SIGNIFICANCE

p = 0.617 uncorrected | p = 0.617 Holm (family of 3)

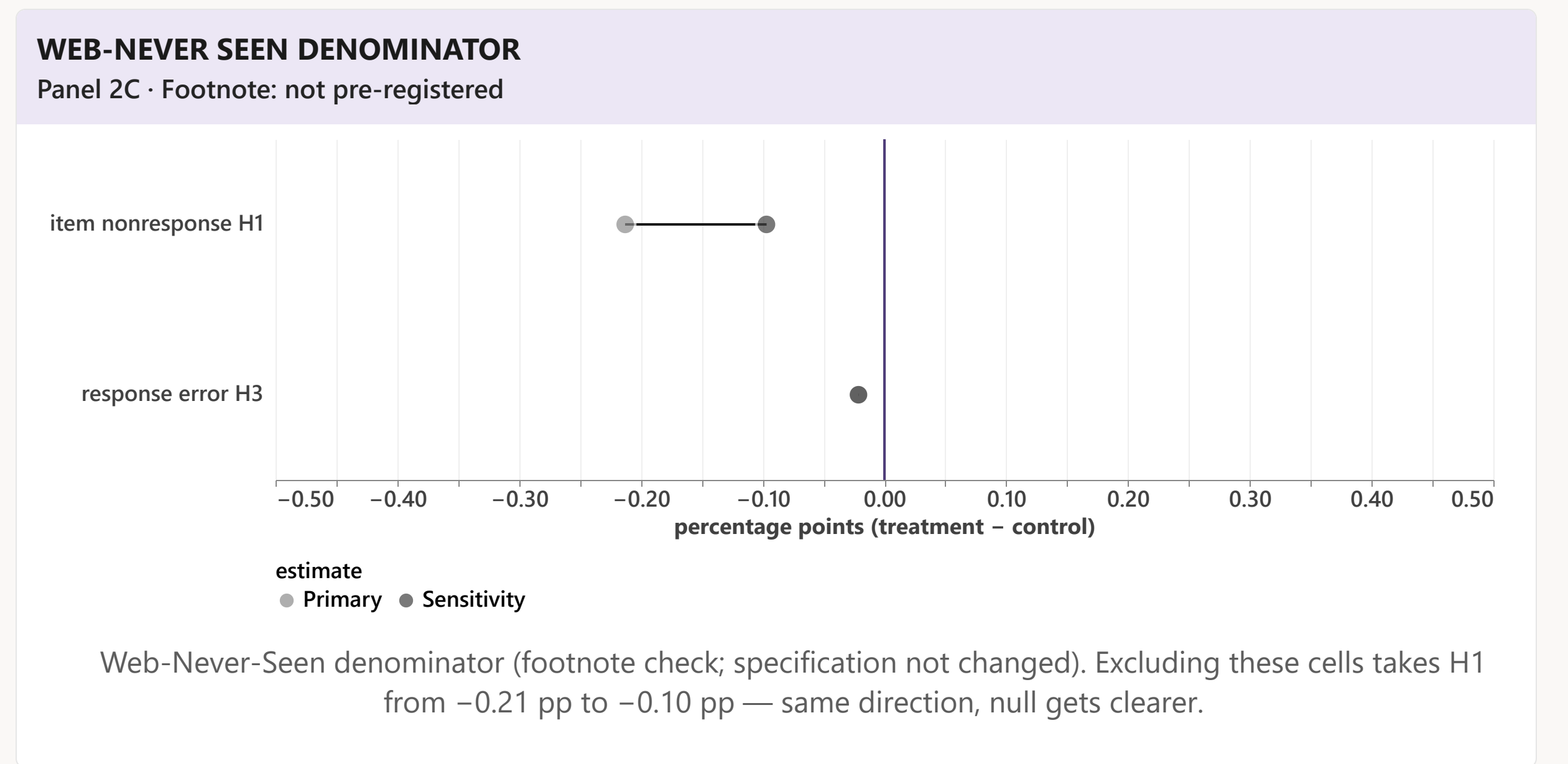
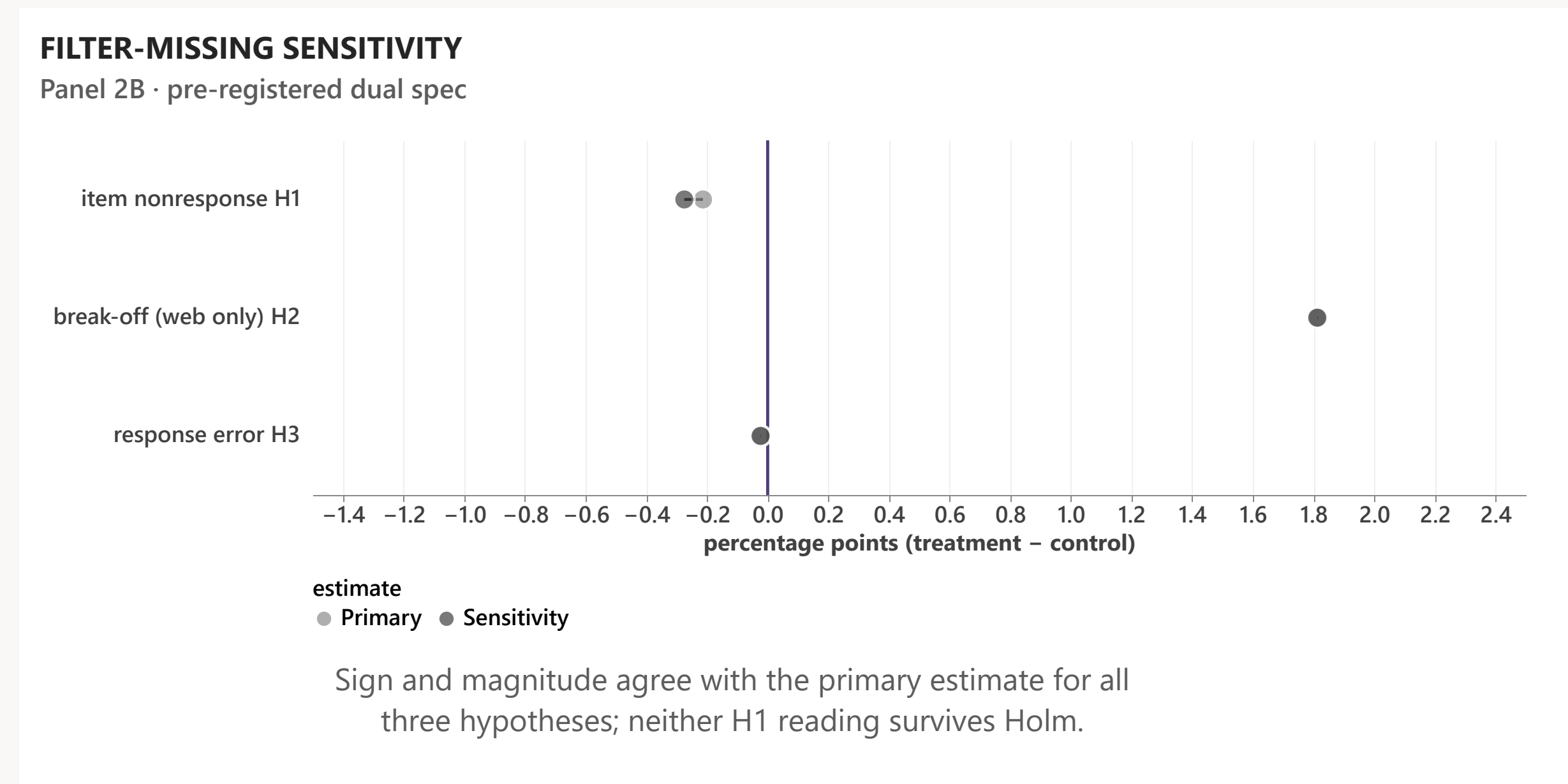
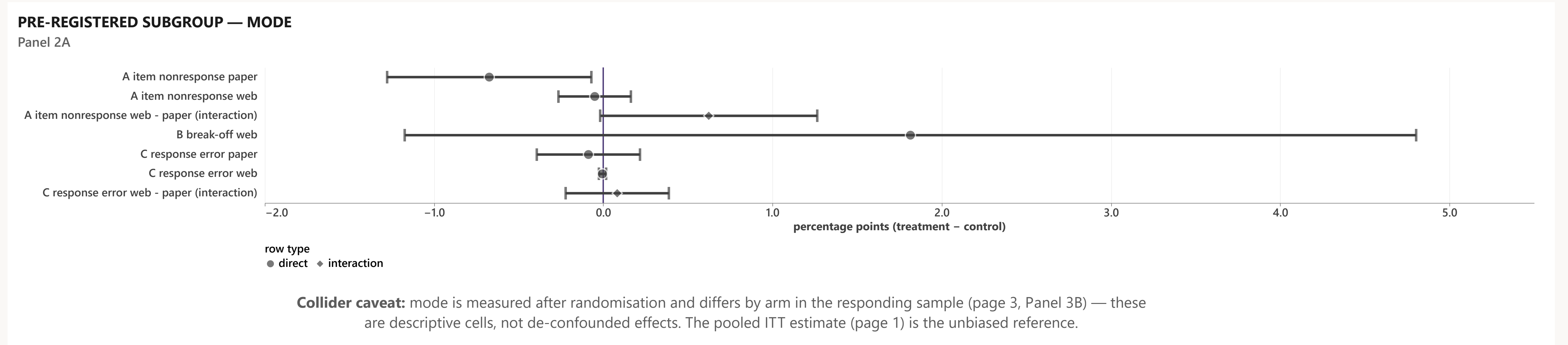
VERDICT

No measurable effect on response error (–0.02 pp). The outcome's too rare for this study's yardstick to say either way.



Robustness — pre-registered checks

One exception, tagged below: Panel 2C is a footnote check, not pre-registered.



Appendix — post-hoc & descriptive

Pre-registered · 3A

Post-hoc · 3B

Not randomised · 3C, 3D

MULTIPLICITY STRIP

Panel 3A · Holm-Bonferroni, family of 3

Holm-Bonferroni over the three pre-registered outcome families. The correction family is fixed by the plan, not by how many tests completed. None of the three survive; adding the two pre-registered mode-interaction tests (family of 5) changes nothing.

H1 — HOLM P.

0.190

H2 — HOLM P.

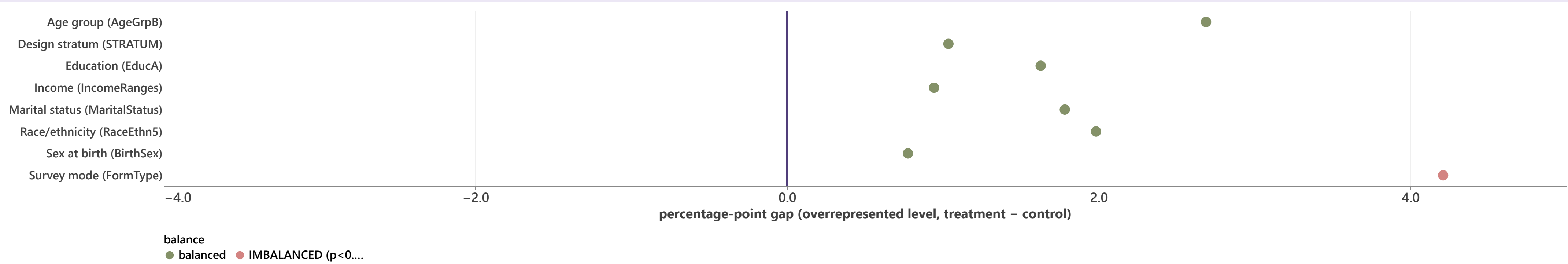
0.467

H3 — HOLM P.

0.617

BALANCE CHECK • POST-HOC — NOT PRE-REGISTERED

Panel 3B · conditional on response



Deferred from Phase 1, covariate set not pre-specified. 7 of 8 balanced including the design stratum; survey mode differs (70.1% vs 65.9% web, p = 0.002) — reported, not adjusted; null within each mode (Panel 2A).

NON-RANDOMISED — NOT CAUSAL

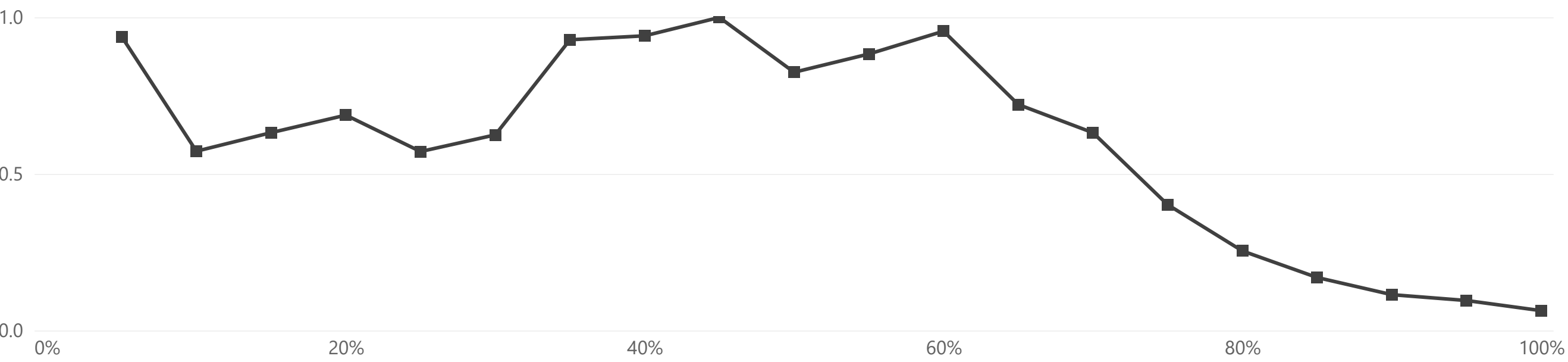
Panel 3C

group	n	rate_pct	ci_lo_pct	ci_hi_pct
Agreed	1389	1.17	0.98	1.35
Did not agree	124	1.86	1.14	2.58
Descriptive difference	1513	-0.69	-1.43	0.05
Declined only	14			

Agreement tracks engagement and education — selection, not effect. The 14 who declined are described, not tested.

ILLUSTRATION — NOT EVIDENCE

Panel 3D (optional inset) · cumulative p-value under repeated looking



The series reads +0.17 pp at 10% of the sample and −0.21 pp at 100% — a sign reversal, not a trend toward significance. That's noise from peeking at incomplete data.

All 31 estimates logged in assertion_history.csv passed the implied_n ≤ respondents guard; implied_n / n ranged 0.16–0.79. (The 31 rows are the pre-registered ITT and subgroup estimates plus the pooled, Filter-Missing and Web-Never-Seen sensitivity estimates the guard also ran on; an earlier draft of this footnote said 27, before the Web-Never-Seen block was added.) Arm-split rates and SEs reproduced three ways (weighting.py, from-scratch numpy, R survey) to 6 decimal places. Withdrawn Phase 5 figures (H1 z = −13.14, H3 z = −3.53) are superseded.